

Isn't the Amazon logo and the theory behind it really cool? If you didn't know, the arrow from A to Z signifies that products of all kinds are available here. Would you like to use the same logo? Sorry, no can do. It's protected with several registrations. Nobody likes the kafka-esque bureaucracy associated with any kind of registrations but some are just necessary for your own protection. And nothing is more important than your identity – in this case, your corporate identity. Oh and just to make things interesting, there's more than one type of intellectual property protection.

Brand registration comprises of registrations of trademark, business, domain and copyright. Trademark registration is the only registration that ensures absolute brand name protection. A business registration is the process of obtaining and legalising the name of the entity that reflects on the bank account of the business, tax registration, legal documents, employment contracts etc. A domain registration means creating an exclusive virtual presence with a web name that relates only to you or your business and brand. Copyright registration and protection is used for literary, dramatic, musical, artistic works, production of cinematographic films and sound recordings as well.

This is even more important if you are going to be marketing your own branded products. Although, there is a cost and gestation period involved, the margins are higher in establishing your own brand rather reselling. In this case, you will need to register your brand name and the logo, ensure that it is properly protected and that you cannot be accused of plagiarism. This is registering more than a company or domain name. This gives you protection in the online as well offline markets.

Importance of branding – A few examples

The secret society of pictorial clues

Ever wondered what the four circles in Audi are? Rumour has it that it represents the four companies that formed a part of the auto-union consortium in way back in 1932. Did you notice the little white arrow between the E and the X in FedEx? It points straight ahead which represent moving forward. These are clear examples of how a trademark can communicate in short bursts to your consumers.



Every logo tells a unique story. Use this opportunity to tell your story your way and to stand out in the crowd